RSS Digest
Generated at: 2026-10-11 14:53:15

1. Dwarf Fortress uses version control now
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-11T00:52:37+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/11/dwarf-fortress/
I remember hearing a while ago that Dwarf Fortress didn’t use version control. That fact has been lodged in my head, because given its inherent complexity I have trouble imagining a codebase that would benefit from version control more . That’s art. I went looking and I’m sad to report that the days without version control appear to have ended. Quoting Tarn Adams over time: March 2013: "I don’t use version control -- I didn’t like the feeling of having the code get committed into a black box thingy with no immediate upside" March 2016: "I don?t even use version control. If you don?t know what that is then you?re not gonna yell at me. If you even know what version control is you?re gonna be like, ?You don?t use version control? You don?t use source control? What is wrong with you? How can you even work? I?m just not cut out for it, in a sense. It?s been 15 years, so the reasons have change over time, but that?s my current understanding of it." March 2023: "I’ve got Discord channels to check and version control stuff to use now, so the process is definitely a little more involved" That March 2023 quote comes from an interview about the release on Steam which made them millionaires ....

2. Python 3.15.0 added to actions/python-versions
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-10T23:58:04+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/10/python-actions/
Python 3.15.0 added to actions/python-versions Bit of a niche link, but I’ve been waiting for this for a couple of days - I even told ChatGPT to check for it: Clone https://github.com/actions/python-versions and git pull once an hour until they add the stable 3.15 - then tell me about it Now that this has landed, you can add "3.15" to a GitHub Actions testing matrix to run tests against the new Python 3.15.0 release . Tags: github , python , github-actions , chatgpt

3. A new feature for my blog, built using my voice
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-09T12:54:06+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/9/built-using-my-voice/
I shipped a new feature for my blog today: the Newsletters page, which offers an index of all of the newsletters I’ve sent out, both my free weekly Substack and my monthly sponsors-only updates. I built the feature almost entirely using my voice, chatting away to my laptop while I cooked dinner. Codex voice mode I used the ChatGPT desktop app for this, in the Codex tab, using the voice conversation mode, running against a local development environment. Here’s what that looks like: I started the session against my local simonwillisonblog checkout by typing: Start dev server and open in browser This gave me a preview of the site that it would be working on, and meant that I could later ask it to show me the new pages so I could visually track its progress. Then I clicked the "Start new voice chat" button - that’s not the microphone button, it’s the one to the right of it - and set my laptop up in the kitchen so I could talk to it while I cooked. Talking to my computer I had a pretty good idea of what I wanted to build, and it’s a simple enough Django feature that I was certain the model (in this case GPT-6 Astra High) would be able to do it. A new model, a migration, some view code,...

4. Sunnny
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-10T16:11:45Z
Link: https://sunnny.com/
My thanks to Sunnny for sponsoring this week at DF. How can B2B software be so friggin? delicious? Find out when early access launches on Monday, October 19. ?

5. ?Proof-of-Human?
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-10T16:06:17Z

Link: https://x.com/bzamayo/status/2108498107184934914
Benjamin Mayo (on X, of course), commenting on Apple promoting behind-the-scenes footage showing that the cross-stitch ?Welcome Home? logo for next week?s keynote/experience was stitched by hand: There needs to be a name for this phenomenon where every published piece of art by a company is now accompanied by a proof-of-human video. I agree, and I think Mayo coined the term right there. It?s always been fun to see footage of talented artists and craftspeople making things by hand. But in the age of AI it?s a differentiator ? not just that you aren?t lazily generating your art via prompts, but that you understand that heart comes from the human hand. ?

6. Inside a 1980s filter chip that uses switched capacitors
Source: Ken Shirriff's blog | Published: 2026-10-10T09:40:25.632-07:00
Link: http://www.righto.com/2026/10/ML10-switched-capacitor-filter.html
Sometimes it's easier to identify an IC with a microscope. While sorting a box of old ICs, CuriousMarc came across some Harris ICs labeled "F1-10-5", a mysterious part number that didn't show up in any databooks. Since unidentifiable ICs are useless, he gave me one to analyze. Conveniently, it was in a ceramic package, so I could open it up with a quick tap from a chisel. Under the microscope, the chip's most striking feature was a grid of square capacitors. With all those capacitors, I guessed that it was a switched-capacitor filter. The die provided another clue: the part number HF-10. With this information, we quickly found that the chip was Harris's version of the standard MF10 switched-capacitor filter chip. 1 The Harris integrated circuit, labeled F1-10-5 (or maybe FI-10-5), with a 1985 date code. Photo courtesy of CuriousMarc. Switched-capacitor filters were a popular way to implement analog filters in the 1980s. Rapidly switching capacitors in and out of a circuit enabled the construction of single-chip filters that were easy to use and performed well. The MF10, introduced by National Semiconductor in 1981, provides two flexible filters on a chip; each filter acts as a low...

7. Some quick thoughts on Unit Testing ActivityPub
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Sat, 10 Oct 2026 11:34:15 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/some-thoughts-on-unit-testing-activitypub/
I'll be radically honest here - I never really got the idea of "Test Driven Development". I'm much more of a "telnet into production and damn the consequences" kind of guy. Look, it's much more fun and my cardiologist recommends severe shocks every now and again. The essence of unit testing is pretty simple: Feed a function some data See how it responds Send it good data and if it returns?

8. This Week in Package Management: 10 October 2026
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-10T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/10/this-week-in-package-management.html
This week?s package management news, gathered from the package manager OPML feed collection , my posts and boosts on Mastodon , and anything people sent me. The collection now includes the vlt blog and vlt CLI releases . Releases uv 0.13.0 makes Python 3.15 the default download, prefers native ARM64 interpreters on Windows ARM64, and changes the cache format, so dependencies may be downloaded or rebuilt after upgrading. It now honours --require-hashes in constraints files included with -c and rejects editable requirements in them, so installs that previously passed can fail. Astral?s Python 3.15 post also covers a build-lazy-imports preview that runs build backends under -X lazy_imports=all . Astral measured wheel builds up to 18% faster with it. pnpm 12.11 installs and signature-checks the Rust toolchain named in rust-toolchain.toml , and links skills/ /SKILL.md files shipped by direct dependencies into directories such as .claude/skills once they are approved with pnpm approve . A new permissions setting records what each dependency may do, with its build capability taking precedence over allowBuilds . 12.10 added an experimental loaded node linker that loads compatible dependen...

9. Reading List 10/10/26
Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 10 Oct 2026 14:55:48 GMT

Link: https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-101026
Propane in air conditioners, Anduril making submarine parts, nuclear reactors on the moon, the robotic hand landscape, and more.